

despite that, there was growth over time (thank you, dividends and compounding!).

Combining my retirement plan investments with my non-retirement investment accounts and my other savings, I had built up a pretty sweet portfolio of assets. And to think that this would have been a different story if I had listened to that little voice in my younger self's head that thought investing was a random scheme and instead had been like “*Nah*, I'll pass,” when it came time to sign up for that very first 401(k). That small action became the catalyst for the investments I made in my employers' plans, my interest in learning about how investing worked, my actions of setting up my non-retirement accounts and growing my portfolio, and now this very book you have in your hands on the topic of investing.

Today, I continue my investing journey alongside my husband. I'm also now investing for my children's futures and teaching them how to invest in order to give them an even better head start than I had. My goal is to pass down not just generational wealth, but knowledge and good financial values as well.

Looking back, my investing story is an example of the saying “little drops of water make a mighty ocean” and a reminder that all you have to do is simply get started. It's easy to overthink yourself into a standstill, fear the unknown, and let inertia stop you from doing anything at all. But, when you set the intent to succeed and start taking action, no matter how small at first, it's just a matter of time before you start to reap the rewards.

NOTES

- 1 https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gender_pay_gap_in_the_United_States#By_race.
- 2 <https://www.sofi.com/blog/women-investing-gender-wealth-gap-nobody-talks/>.
- 3 <https://www.fidelity.com/about-fidelity/individual-investing/better-investor-men-or-women>.